conduit for talks with Chirag Paswan and his Lok Janshakti Party (Ram Vilas). Pradhan, who was made Bihar poll in-charge in September, has an easy rapport with chief minister Nitish Kumar, which proved invaluable when matters got testy during the seat-sharing talks.

THE NO-GAPS STRATEGY

Months ahead of the polling, the BJP had established a dedicated election war room in Bihar to centralise planning, logistics and real-time decision-making. Delhi-based entrepreneur and party functionary Rohan Gupta, who had run similar campaign set-ups in Haryana, Jharkhand and Delhi, was put in charge. The war room network extended to 92,000 booth-level agents (BLAs) across Bihar. Servicing their requests were some 150 volunteers, hired by the party for the call centre set up in the war room.

Unlike the dramatic optics of national campaigns, Bihar 2025 was run on documents—SOPs, spreadsheets, daily call logs. Every booth-level committee maintained a seven-day, two-day, and polling-day checklist. Each mandal prepared a 'five-voter sheet' identifying households with five or more electors, complete with phone numbers and likely preferences. The conveyor belt of national stars, including an array of party CMs, such as UP's Yogi Adityanath and Delhi's Rekha Gupta, helped amplify messages, fill stadiums and create a perception of non-stop momentum. The blanket coverage extended to polling day, with RSS swayamsevaks monitoring turnout lists and even calling voters to remind them to come out and exercise their franchise.

The blanket coverage extended to polling day, with RSS men monitoring turnout lists and even calling voters to remind them to come out and vote

Data teams in Patna prepared caste-composition charts for every constituency, often advising even allies on candidate profiles. If a seat required a Koeri or Kushwaha face, suggestions came from the BJP office. For example, when Upendra Kushwaha, leader of the Rashtriya Lok Morcha (RLM), proposed fielding his wife Snehlata, the alliance routed her to Sasaram, a decision that later delivered a comfortable win. This sort of coordination was possible because Pradhan and Tawde operated as travelling troubleshooters. They camped for days in Gaya, Darbhanga and Purnea, mediating in quarrels, reallocating resources and, crucially, ensuring that RSS functionaries and party managers were on the same page. Their 'no gaps strategy' became the BJP campaign's informal slogan.



COMING THROUGH PM Modi with CM Nitish, deputy CM Samrat Choudhary at a rally in Purnea, Sept. 15

MANNING THE FORTS

The NDA leadership knew it had a tough fight on its hands, and that it needed to come out all guns blazing. As late as June, BJP insiders say, when the first election posters appeared, the NDA was still very apprehensive. Nitish's personal image was dividing opinion, and seat-sharing talks were going nowhere. By contrast, Tejashwi's sparkle was the talk of the town, while Prashant Kishor's Jan Suraaj Yatra was drawing large crowds. Realising they had no time to lose, the NDA partners got their act together. By the time the poll dates were announced, they were talking booth logistics while the MGB was still haggling over seats.

Among the big changes the NDA made this time was a 'structural reordering', dividing the state into five organisational zones for sharper micro-management. So, there was the Patna zone (covering Patna, Nalanda and Nawada); Magadh and Shahabad (including Bhojpur and Rohtas); Kosi, Seemanchal and Anga (across Purnia, Katihar and Bhagalpur); Saran and Champaran (Saran, Siwan, and East